

KAIF TARASGAR

Penetration Tester | Offensive Security Analyst | Bug Bounty Researcher

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Penetration Tester and Offensive Security Analyst with hands-on experience in web application VAPT, red team operations, and bug bounty research. Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH v12), CompTIA PenTest+, CompTIA Security+, CISSP Specialization, CRTOM, and FCA certified. **1st place – IU Hack2Xploit 3.0** (Defcon Pune Chapter, 600+ participants). Issued 5 responsible disclosure certificates from leading enterprises. Technical Lead at CREST Cybersecurity Club and Campus Ambassador at E-Cell IIT Bombay. Skilled in OWASP Top 10 exploitation, network forensics, incident response, and security advisory writing across 10+ internships.

EXPERIENCE

Cyber Security Intern – *Hacktify Cyber Security LLP*

Apr – Jul 2026

- Web application pen testing on client engagements – identified SQLi, XSS, IDOR, authentication bypass, and privilege escalation via Burp Suite; authored CVSS-scored advisory reports with PoC chains and OWASP-aligned remediation.

Fortinet Network Security Associate Intern – *EduSkills (AICTE x Fortinet)*

Apr – Jun 2026

- Earned Fortinet Certified Associate (FCA) with Grade O; configured FortiGate firewall policies, site-to-site VPNs, IPS profiles, and FortiSIEM correlation rules in enterprise environments.

Cybersecurity Intern – **Gen-AI and Cloud Security** – *Edunet x VOIS for Tech (AICTE)*

Mar – Apr 2026

- Built AI-augmented threat detection pipeline integrating LLMs with SIEM correlation; implemented Zero-Trust controls and automated incident response playbooks.

Cyber Security Intern – *CyberWarLab*

Mar – Apr 2026

- Black-box and grey-box pen tests; applied MITRE ATT&CK TTPs – lateral movement, C2 via Sliver; produced formal findings reports with exploit chains.

Cyber Security and Ethical Hacking Intern – *Cryptonic Area*

Jan – Mar 2026

- Full-stack VAPT covering authentication bypass, privilege escalation, and web security; awarded CEO Letter of Recommendation; delivered CVSS-rated advisory reports.

Web Exploit Hunting and Bug Bounty Intern – *EduSkills Academy (AICTE)*

Oct – Dec 2025

- Ranked **Outstanding (Grade O)**; OWASP Top 10 exploitation (SQLi, XSS, SSRF, XXE, SSTI), PoC development, and professional bug reporting with IoC documentation.

Cyber Security Intern – **Advanced Level** – *ShadowFox*

Sep – Oct 2025

- Network pen testing, password cracking, hash analysis via Metasploit, Nmap, Wireshark; threat actor profiling in isolated enterprise lab environments.

Additional Internships: Palo Alto NGFW/SIEM/SOC (AICTE, Jul–Sep 2025) | Zscaler Zero Trust Cloud Security (Jan–Mar 2025) | Prodigy InfoTech (Jul–Aug 2025) | VaultofCodes/CodSoft Python Security (Aug–Sep 2025) | EduSkills Ethical Hacking (Apr–Jun 2025) | Edunet/IBM AI-ML (Dec 2025–Jan 2026)

EDUCATION

BSc Cyber Security and Forensics

Expected Apr 2027

Pimpri Chinchwad University, Pune | Network Security, Ethical Hacking, Digital Forensics, Incident Response

LEADERSHIP

Technical Lead – *CREST Cybersecurity Club*

Current

- Lead offensive security programs for 100+ members; organized CREST CTF (2,000+ registrants) – designed Web Exploitation and OSINT challenges. Felicitated by Vice Chancellor Dr. Sonavane.

Campus Ambassador – **E-Cell IIT Bombay**

Current

Promote entrepreneurship and innovation ecosystem at Pimpri Chinchwad University; drive startup awareness and innovation challenges.

Volunteer – PCCOE Job Fair 2026

Apr 2026

Company Point of Contact for International Automotive Components at event with 200+ companies and 15,000+ students.

BUG BOUNTY AND RESPONSIBLE DISCLOSURE

Perfios – User Enumeration via Differential Error Messages

Certificate of Appreciation – Mar 2026

OWASP A07: `/api/login` vs `/api/sendPasswordResetOTP` returned distinct responses for registered vs. unregistered emails, enabling unauthenticated account enumeration. Submitted curl PoC and generic error remediation.

Sai Life Sciences – DMARC Subdomain Misconfiguration (`sp=none`)

Certificate – CISO Srikanth JS, Mar 2026

OWASP A05: Root `p=quarantine` but `*.sailife.com` had zero DMARC enforcement, enabling BEC spoofing; provided `dig` PoC and recommended `sp=quarantine` or `sp=reject`.

Max Healthcare – CORS Misconfiguration and PII Exposure

Responsible Disclosure – Feb 2026

OWASP A05: Permissive CORS + unauthenticated API endpoints exposed patient PII; submitted CORS hardening advisory and access control remediation guidance.

TMF Group – IDOR in Financial Document API

Responsible Disclosure – May 2026

OWASP A01: Sequential document ID enumeration allowed cross-org financial data access; vendor applied fix within 48 hours.

ELAN Limited – User Enumeration – Login/Password Reset

200rs Bug Bounty – Feb 2026

OWASP A07: Differential error messages on internal helpdesk; rewarded for independent discovery and quality of remediation guidance.

PROJECTS

CipherX Pro v4.2.0

Python, FastAPI, Asyncio

- AI-powered universal decoder – 73+ operations (Base64, Hex, XOR, ROT) with recursive detection, 8 parallel decoders, LRU caching, and sub-10ms latency. Designed for deobfuscating C2 payloads in network forensics and malware analysis.

PCAP-StoryTeller

Python

- Network forensics tool transforming PCAP files into attack storyboards – automated threat detection, IP geolocation maps of threat actors, attack graph visualization, and forensic report generation for incident response.

Banking-Security-Platform

Python

- Enterprise banking security simulation – MFA, real-time fraud detection, transaction anomaly monitoring, security event alerting. Threat modelling for credential stuffing and session hijacking attack surfaces.

Packet-Scope

Python

- Real-time packet analyzer – deep payload inspection, protocol statistics, IP geolocation mapping of source addresses, malicious IP alerting. Supports intrusion detection and IoC identification in live traffic.

Open-source at github.com/Kaif-T-200

CTF AND ACHIEVEMENTS

1st Place – IU Hack2Xploit 3.0

Indira University x Defcon Pune Chapter | Apr 2026

12-hour solo (600+ participants) – Web Exploitation, Forensics and Steganography, Reverse Engineering, Cryptography, AI/ML Security, OSINT. 19+ flags captured, 1st place.

Technical Lead – CREST CTF 2026

Pimpri Chinchwad University | Feb 2026

8-hour competition (2,000+ registrants); designed Web Exploitation and OSINT challenges. Felicitated by Vice Chancellor Dr. Sonavane.

Other: ISEA ISAP CTF 2026 (IIT Madras) | SYNAPSE 2025 CTF (24-hr offline) | H7CTF 2025 (EC-Council) | Chaitanya CTF | ZERODAY CTF | Digital CyberHunt CTF | and more.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Offensive Security: Web Application VAPT, SQLi, XSS, IDOR, SSRF, XXE, SSTI, Auth Bypass, PrivEsc, Lateral Movement, Red Teaming, OSINT, Bug Bounty Research

Defensive and Forensics: Network Forensics, Memory Forensics, IoC Analysis, Incident Containment, Threat Profiling, SIEM, SOAR, SOC Operations, Digital Forensics

Tools: Metasploit, Burp Suite Pro, Wireshark, Nmap, Kali Linux, Sliver C2, Packet Tracer, SET, Microsoft Defender

Languages: Python, JavaScript, Bash, SQL, HTML/CSS, React.js

Frameworks: OWASP Top 10, MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, CVSSv3, CTF Challenge Design

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

- Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH v12) – Coursera/Packt (Jun 2025)
- CompTIA PenTest+ (PT0-002) – Coursera (Sep 2025)
- CISSP Specialization (4 courses) – Infosec/Coursera (Feb 2026)
- Certified Red Team Ops Management (CRTOM) – Red Team Leaders (Dec 2025)
- Fortinet Certified Associate (FCA) – Fortinet Training Institute (Jun 2026)
- CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) – KodeKloud (Feb 2026)
- CSEDP, 93% Merit – The SecOps Group (Jun 2026)
- Junior GRC Analyst (JGA) – Vibe Security (Apr 2026)
- Linux and Web Bug Bounty Bootcamp – CappricioSec (Mar 2026)

Additional: Google Cybersecurity | Microsoft Cybersecurity Analyst | Azure Security Tools | CRPO, 98% | Palo Alto Security Ops | ZTCA (Zscaler) | Cloud Infra Analyst (NASSCOM) | AI Security (Zscaler) | Gen AI (Databricks) | Proactive Cyber (CDAC/MeitY) | McKinsey Forward